

FBI disrupts massive AI-powered phishing service using a million URLs

CyberIntel Threat Advisory - automated analysis of source reporting: affected systems, actor attribution, and recommended actions.

INTELLIGENCE SNAPSHOT

Issued by	CyberIntel
Date	18 June 2026
Source	bleepingcomputer
Region	China
Threat Level	CRITICAL
Focus	Phishing-as-a-Service
Motivations	Financial
Prominent Actors	Outsider Enterprise
Primary Tactics	Phishing, AI-powered phishing kits, Telegram coordination
Affected Systems / Vendors	Android, AT&T, T-Mobile, Verizon
CVEs	None identified
Reference	https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/fbi-disrupts-massive-ai-powered-phishing-service-using-a-million-urls/
Classification	For Authorised Recipients

Executive Summary

The FBI, in collaboration with Google and Black Lotus Labs, has dismantled a massive Chinese phishing-as-a-service operation known as Outsider Enterprise. This operation has been active since at least 2023 and has used AI-powered phishing kits to impersonate trusted brands, resulting in the theft of over 3.8 million credit card records and an estimated \$1.9 billion in losses. The operation involved thousands of phishing websites and over a million fraudulent URLs, with the threat actors using Telegram to coordinate their efforts. The takedown of Outsider Enterprise is part of the FBI's larger Operation Riptide, which targets cybercrime activity and infrastructure. Google has filed a civil lawsuit targeting the operation's infrastructure and is working with telecommunications service providers to block fraudulent messages. The company estimates that hundreds of thousands of victims have lost millions to these scams. The disruption of Outsider Enterprise highlights the growing threat of AI-powered phishing operations and the need for coordinated efforts to combat cybercrime. The operation's use of AI and distributed phishing kits has made it a significant threat, and the takedown demonstrates the importance of collaboration between law enforcement, private companies, and governments to disrupt and prevent such operations.

■ **THREAT LEVEL: CRITICAL**

FOCUS: PHISHING-AS-A-SERVICE

Threat Actor Profiles & Operational Structure

Outsider Enterprise

A Chinese phishing-as-a-service operation

Capabilities: AI-powered phishing kits, distributed phishing kits, Telegram coordination

Confirmed Activities: Theft of over 3.8 million credit card records, estimated \$1.9 billion in losses

Critical Infrastructure & Notable Sector Impacts

Sector	Targeted Entity / System	Actor	Impact / Method
Financial	Credit card records	Outsider Enterprise	Theft of over 3.8 million credit card records, estimated \$1.9 billion in losses
Telecommunications	AT&T, T-Mobile, Verizon	Outsider Enterprise	Use of telecommunications services to send fraudulent messages

Initial Access Vectors & TTPs

Threat Actor	Documented Attack Vectors & TTPs
Outsider Enterprise	Phishing, AI-powered phishing kits, Telegram coordination
General	Use of social engineering tactics, exploitation of trusted brands

Detection Measures & Mitigation Strategy

- ✓ **AI-powered defenses.** AI-powered defenses can detect and block phishing attempts, including those using AI-powered phishing kits. These defenses can also warn users about suspicious calls and messaging protections can block malicious messages.
- ✓ **Behavioral AI.** Behavioral AI can help security teams automate detection, investigation, and remediation workflows to reduce alert fatigue, accelerate response times, and improve resilience against modern email threats.
- ✓ **Breach and attack simulation.** Breach and attack simulation tests can help security teams identify vulnerabilities and weaknesses in their systems, allowing them to improve their defenses and prevent attacks.
- ✓ **SIEM and EDR rules.** SIEM and EDR rules can help security teams detect and respond to threats, including phishing attempts and other types of cyber attacks. Regular testing and updating of these rules can help ensure their effectiveness.

CyberIntel Strategic Recommendations

- ✓ **Implement AI-powered defenses.** Implementing AI-powered defenses can help detect and block phishing attempts, including those using AI-powered phishing kits. This can help protect users and prevent financial losses.
- ✓ **Use behavioral AI for email security.** Using behavioral AI for email security can help automate detection, investigation, and remediation workflows, reducing alert fatigue and improving resilience against modern email threats.

- ✓ **Conduct regular breach and attack simulation tests.** Conducting regular breach and attack simulation tests can help identify vulnerabilities and weaknesses in systems, allowing security teams to improve their defenses and prevent attacks.
- ✓ **Support bipartisan U.S. anti-scam bills.** Supporting bipartisan U.S. anti-scam bills, such as the Stop SCAMS Act, can help strengthen legal protections against AI-enabled fraud and provide law enforcement with the tools they need to combat cybercrime.

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